Road deaths fell for three decades; now they are rising again

How have road deaths changed since 1989?

Year
1989 2025

State
All

Road User Group
All

Age Group
All

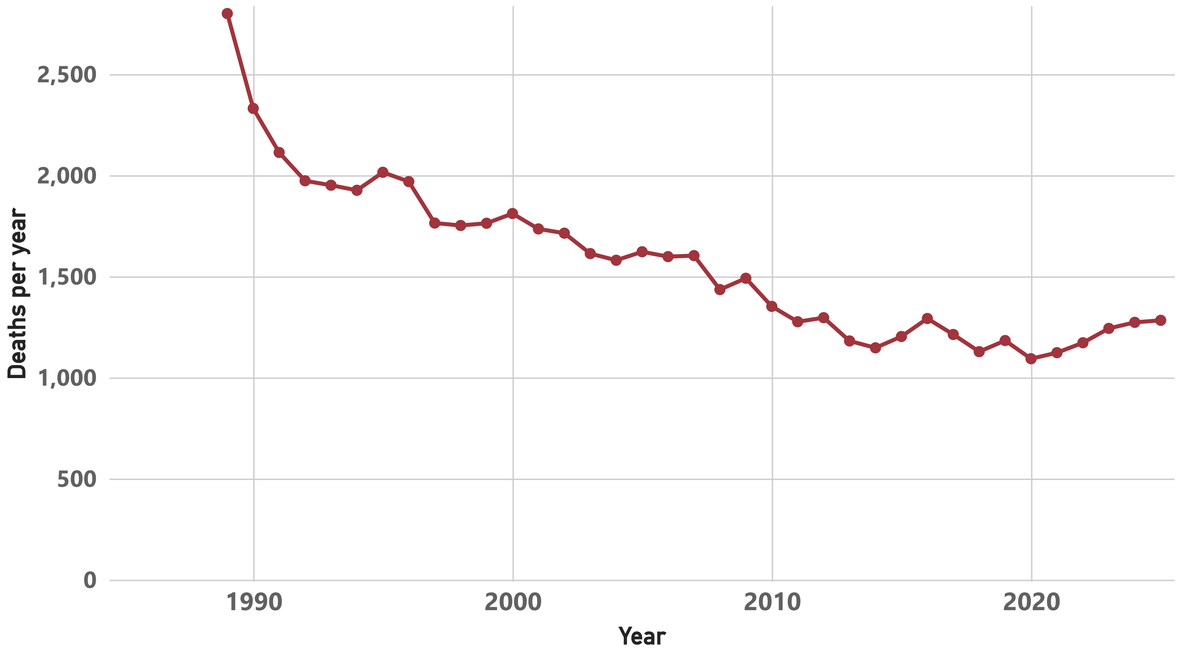
Gender
All

58,017
People Killed (1989-2025)

52,368
Fatal Crashes

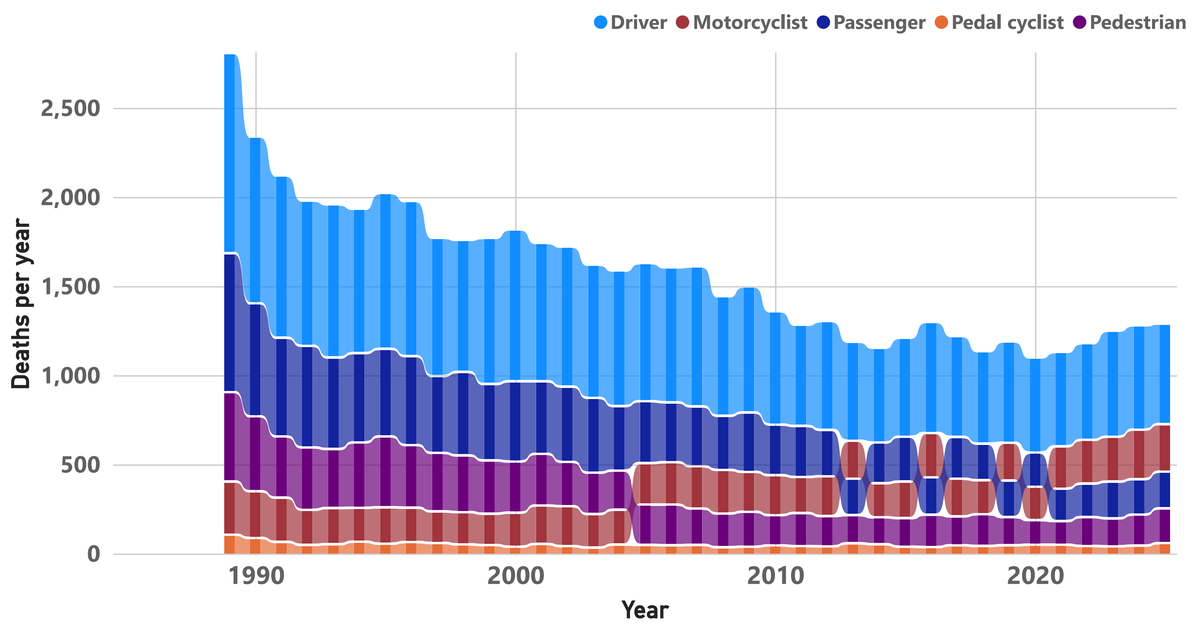
1.11
Average deaths per crash

Road deaths more than halved since 1989, but are rising again



Motorcyclists have climbed from 4th to 2nd among road deaths

Deaths per year by road user, ranked, 1989-2025



Fewer young people are dying, but more older people and motorcyclists are

Which groups account for road deaths, and how has that changed?

Year
1989 2025

State
All

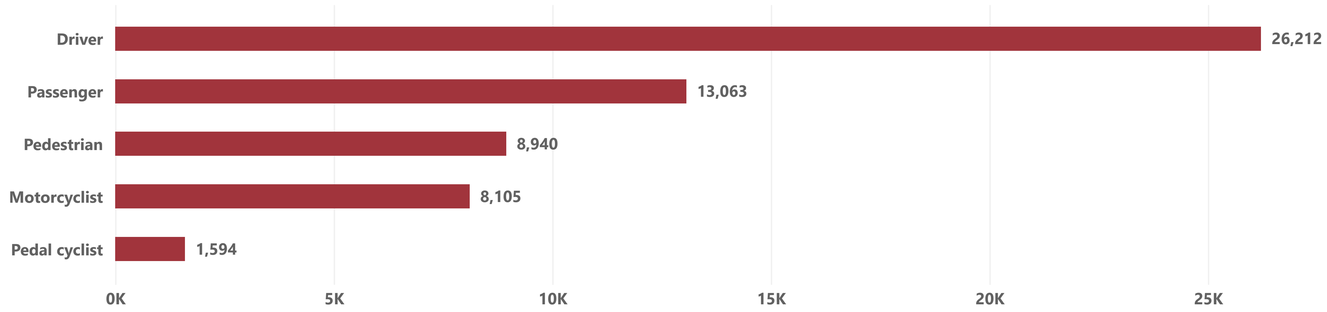
Road User Group
All

Age Group
All

Gender
All

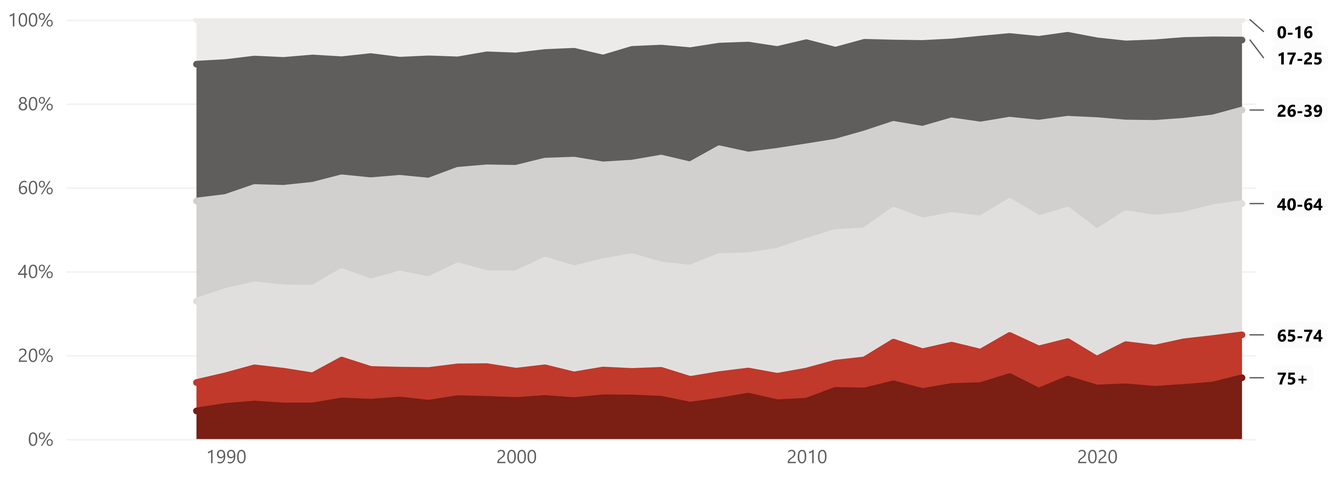
Drivers are almost half of all road deaths

Deaths by type of road user, 1989-2025



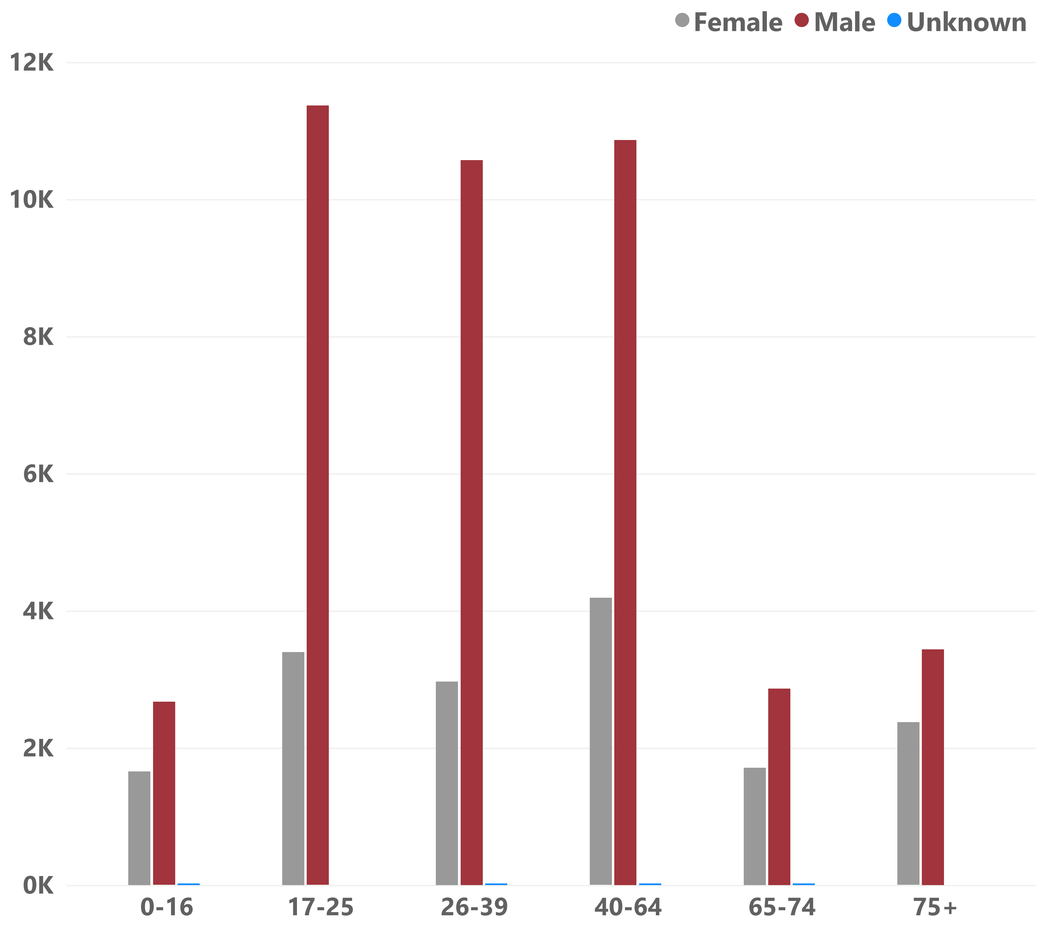
Road deaths are shifting from the young to the old

Share of deaths by age group, 1989-2025



Young men aged 17-25 are the largest group killed

Deaths by age group and gender, 1989-2025



Most deaths happen outside major cities, but city deaths are rising fastest

Where do fatal crashes happen? (2017–2025)

Year
2017 2025

State
All

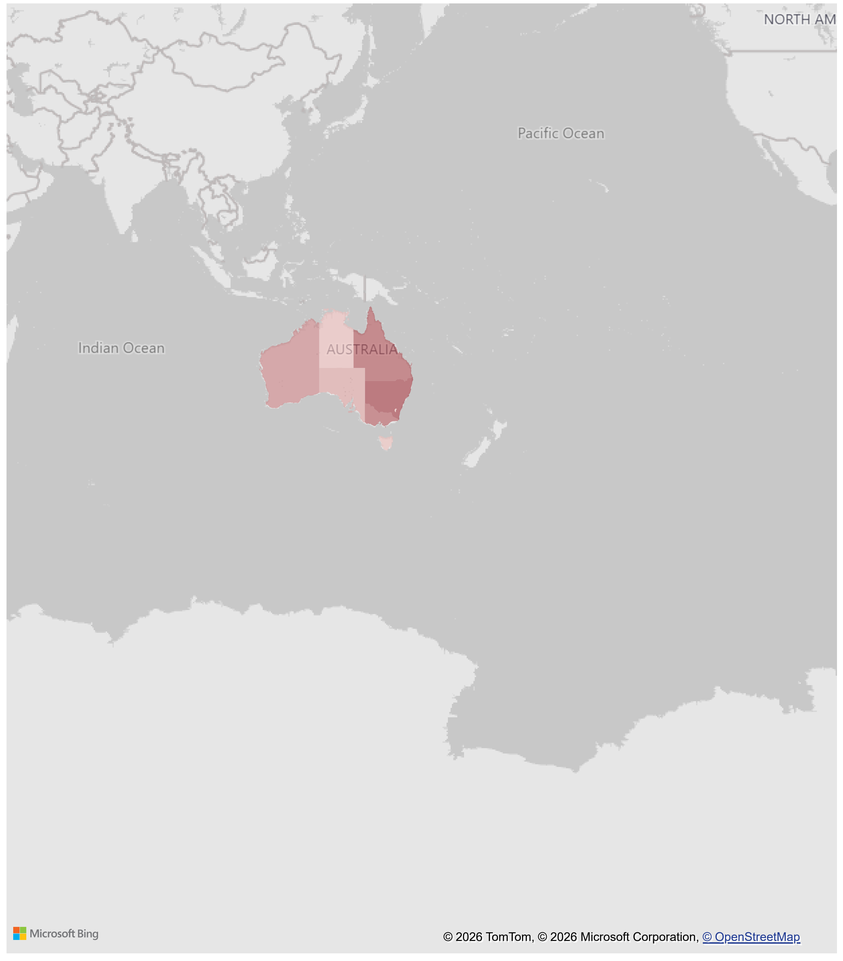
Road User Group
All

Age Group
All

Gender
All

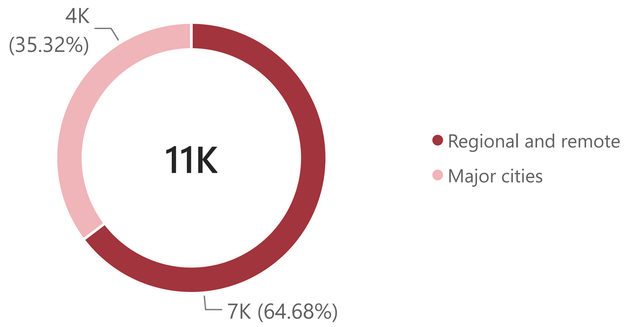
NSW, QLD and VIC have the most deaths

Deaths and % of Deaths by State Location



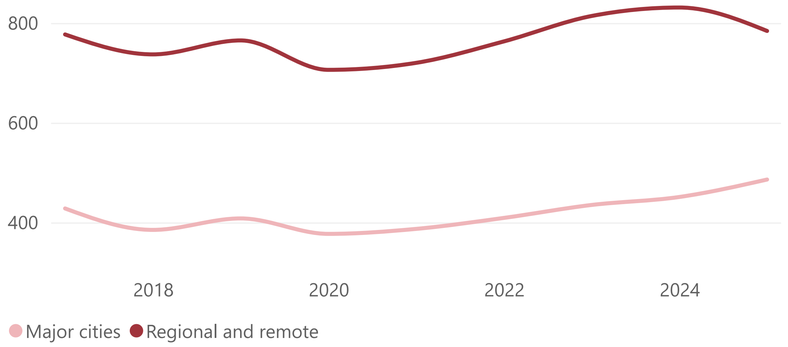
2 in 3 deaths happen outside major cities

Deaths by remoteness areas, 2017-2025



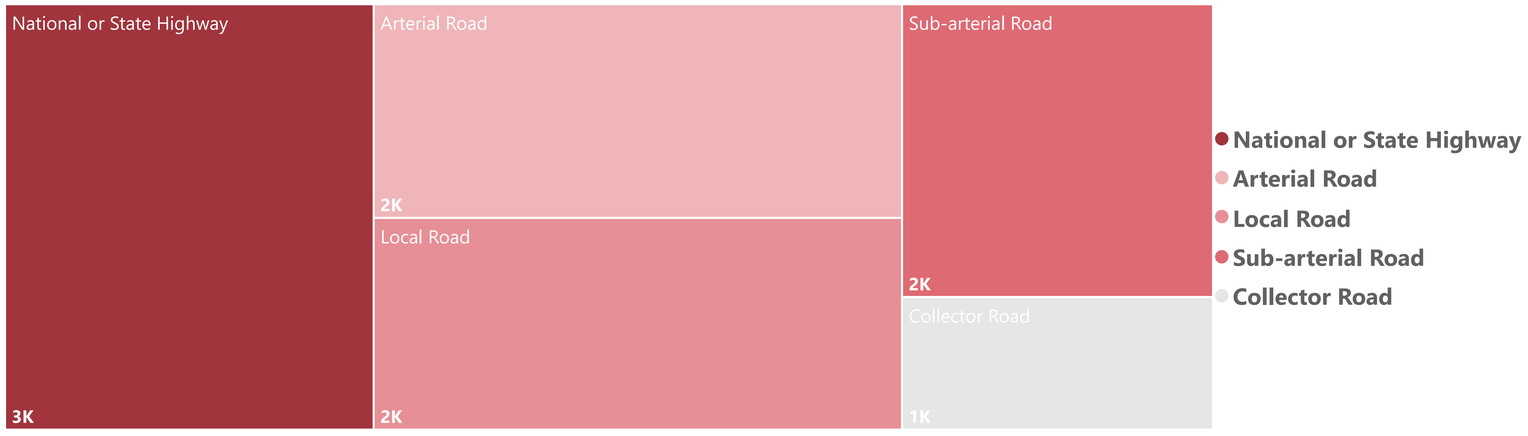
Since 2020, city deaths have risen much faster: +24% vs +6%

Deaths per year, major cities vs regional & remote, 2017-2025



Highways are the deadliest road type

Deaths by National Road Type



Weekends are deadlier than Christmas; Friday afternoon is the peak

When do fatal crashes happen? (2017–2025)

Year
2017 2025

State
All

Road User Group
All

Age Group
All

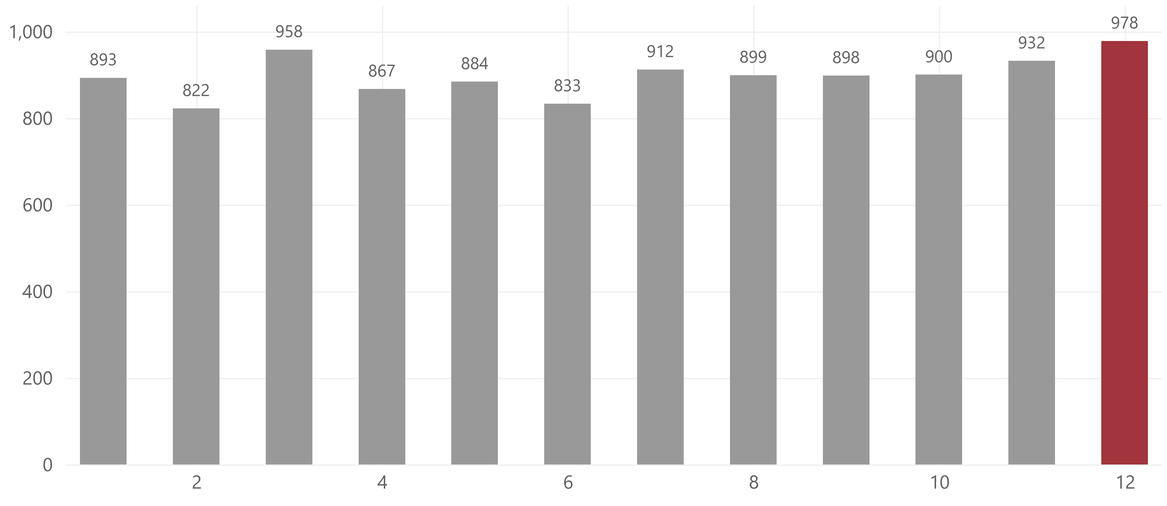
Gender
All

Friday afternoon is the deadliest time of the week

Day	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23
Monday		21	22	20	29	18	42	61	40	61	64	89	81	83	67	87	84	80	80	69	59	48	37	45	28
Tuesday		21	13	23	14	34	40	58	73	56	56	75	71	79	63	66	86	98	90	66	71	44	52	42	33
Wednesday		39	22	8	23	24	43	71	53	44	58	55	74	83	87	101	93	97	81	85	51	54	56	51	58
Thursday		37	21	37	20	24	44	58	53	57	64	73	85	91	77	86	102	90	115	68	69	58	74	52	40
Friday		52	34	30	30	29	48	72	56	58	48	60	85	94	90	107	126	95	107	93	102	75	84	68	80
Saturday		57	71	70	50	48	41	49	52	51	69	79	94	96	90	106	111	85	83	71	92	78	77	76	75
Sunday	1	67	55	54	56	48	36	60	45	58	72	95	111	105	110	95	94	108	83	97	97	49	35	53	53

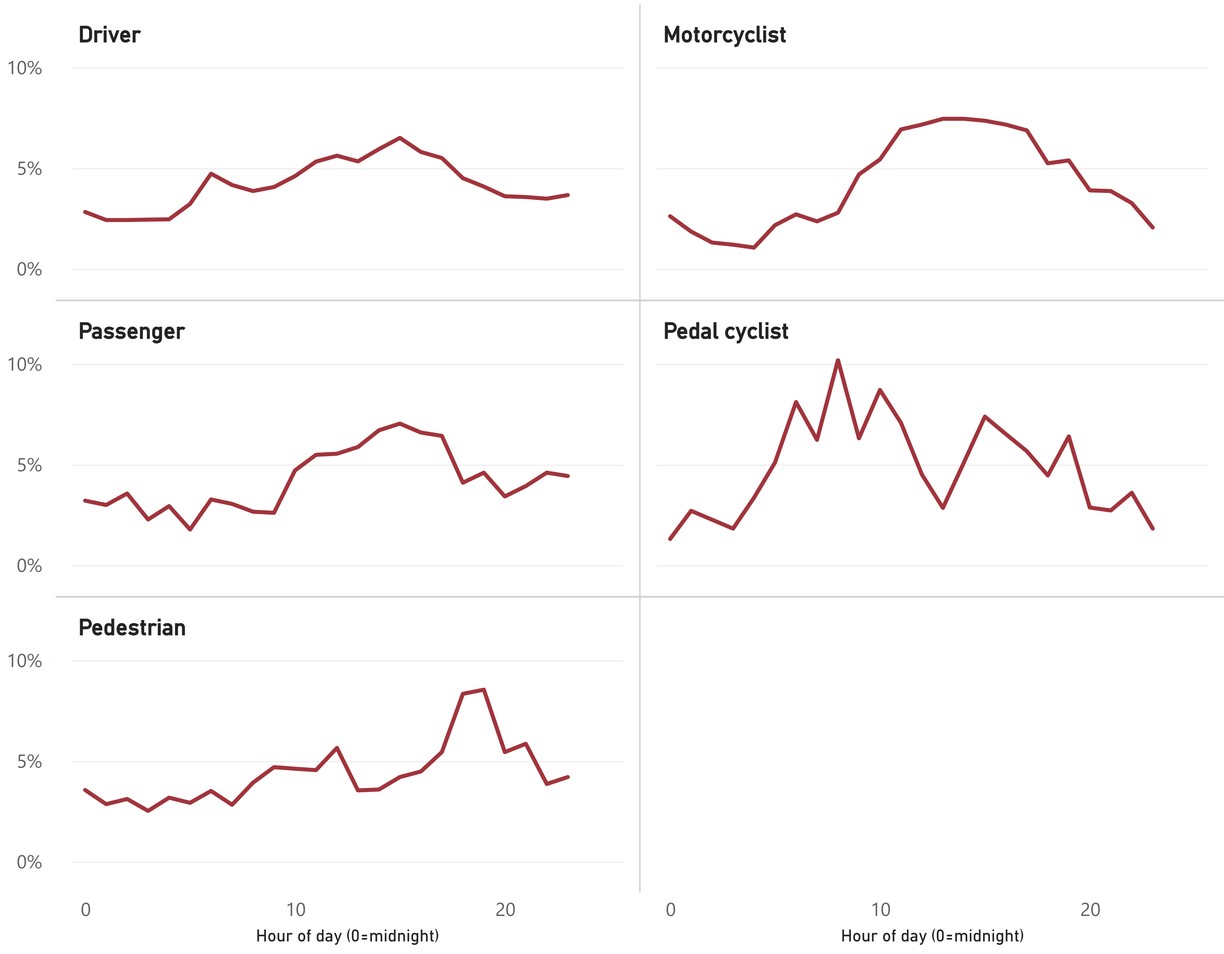
December is the deadliest month

Deaths by month, 2017-2025



Each road user has a different danger hour

Share of each group's deaths by hour of day, 2017-2025



Explore it yourself: how who, where and when combine

Click the + next to any bar to split it further. Try: Motorcyclist --> Gender --> Age Group

Click any + to break down road deaths

